

Python - Setup Instructions

Step 1: Download and Install Miniforge

Windows

1. Download **Miniforge for Windows** from conda-forge.org/download, then double-click the downloaded installer.
2. If Windows displays a protection warning, select **More info > Run anyway**.
3. Use the default installer options and select **Add installation to my PATH environment variable**.
4. After installation, open the **Start menu**, search for **Miniforge Prompt**, and open it.

macOS/Linux/WSL

1. Download the Miniforge installer for your operating system from conda-forge.org/download. Choose the installer for your Mac processor (Apple Silicon or Intel) if prompted.
2. Open **Terminal** and run the installer:

```
Shell
cd ~/Downloads
bash Miniforge3-
```

Press **Enter** after each command. For the second command, press **Tab** to complete the filename, then press **Enter**.

3. Follow the prompts: press **Spacebar** to read the license, type **yes** to accept it, press **Enter** for the default install location, and type **yes** to initialize Miniforge.
4. Close and reopen Terminal when the installation finishes.

Step 2: Install Course Packages

1. Open the [Carpentries environment file](#) in your browser.
2. Right-click an empty area of the page and choose **Save As** (or **Save Page As**).
3. Save the file in your **Downloads** folder with this exact name:

```
None
carpentries_environment.yml
```

4. Open **Miniforge Prompt** on Windows, or **Terminal** on macOS, Linux, or WSL, then run the appropriate command below.

Windows (Miniforge Prompt):

```
Shell
cd Downloads
conda env create -f carpentries_environment.yml
```

macOS / Linux / WSL:

```
Shell
conda env create -f ~/Downloads/carpentries_environment.yml
```

Step 3: Verify Your Setup

Activate the environment and start JupyterLab **from the Miniforge prompt**:

```
Shell
conda activate carpentries # always run this before starting jupyter lab
jupyter lab
```

Your prompt should show **(carpentries)** and JupyterLab should open in your browser.

Troubleshooting: Common Issues

- Restart your terminal or Miniforge Prompt if **conda** is not recognized.
- Check that **carpentries_environment.yml** is in your Downloads folder and that the filename matches exactly.
- If **conda activate carpentries** fails, repeat the environment-creation command and check for error messages.
- Environment creation requires an internet connection and can take several minutes.

Need Help?

If you run into issues during setup or are unsure about any step, contact us at:

training@acenet.ca

Please include: Your operating system (Windows / macOS / Linux), the error message you received (with screenshot if possible), and the course name.